Milestone Grading

Overview

Every project is different, so each student should establish, in consultation with their stakeholder, how much effort will be placed into **Evidence** (research), **Interfaces** (external), and **Systems** (internal). For example, one project may be primarily evidentiary (a research project), while another may focus on development of internal systems (back-end project). Most projects should have some elements of each, except in exceptional circumstances. All of these are further scaled by **Effort**.

For example, a research oriented-project may be weighted as follows:

- 80% Research-Oriented Development (the "meat" of the work)
- 10% Interface (demonstration / proof of concept)
- 10% Systems (demonstration / proof of concept)

On the other hand, an applied back-end / API project may instead be weighted differently:

- 20% Evidence (Research on prior art, etc)
- 60% Systems (primary effort / back-end)
- 20% Interface (public API / proof of concept front end)

...and a Game project might look like this:

- 45% Interface (gameplay / UI)
- 45% Systems (graphics and other subsystems)
- 10% Evidence (identifying potential system layers / algorithms / etc)

All of this should then be scaled according to the expectation of students spending sufficient time on the project. The expected time commitment **per person** for each milestone is as follows:

- Design Plan & Mock-ups: 13 hours
- Pre-Alpha Build: 19 hours
- Design Prototype: 29 hours

In other words, the cumulative time commitment per person on the project, by end of term, should be approx. 60 hours total.